

Karl Petzold

Gaming Campaigns, Social & Influence

Based in Paris, I have spent ten years in video game marketing: six at Blizzard Entertainment on every franchise launch, then four leading the gaming division of Pavillon Noir for Activision, Ubisoft, Tencent, EA and Riot Games, across local, EMEA and global campaigns.

Social, influence, talent, partnerships and performance reporting are the core of my work. I would like to bring that experience, and the way I build and lead teams, to Focus Entertainment Publishing as Communication Director, for games built on original worlds and loyal communities.

Skills

SOCIAL & INFLUENCE

I build social and influence plans around each platform and each community. At Pavillon Noir, I ran KOL programmes for Tencent in France and Germany, worked with talent agencies such as BUMP and Webedia, and with personalities including Guillaume Sanchez, Rudy Gobert, Danny Wallace and Ragnar, each tracked through reach, engagement and views.

CAMPAIGNS & PARTNERSHIPS

Ten years of launches, from the full Blizzard catalogue to Call of Duty, Assassin's Creed and Delta Force, across print, DOOH, FOOH, digital, eCRM, stunts and events. I have also built brand partnership proposals with Crocs, Umbro and Adidas for Borderlands, or with Tealer and Citadium for Ankama, to name a few.

LEADERSHIP

I lead the agency's gaming division and build teams of 4 to 12 people per project, more in production. I have written job descriptions, run around forty recruitment interviews and many annual reviews, and presented strategy to leadership at Blizzard, Tencent, 2K, Ubisoft and Puig.

AI & INNOVATION

I co-built Pavillon Noir's AI practice: 300+ professionals trained across 15+ brands, AI-produced campaigns for Dior and Rabanne, and in-house tools for content production and trend monitoring.

Experience

HEAD OF GAMING & AI
Pavillon Noir
2022 - Current

I joined Pavillon Noir in 2022 to lead its gaming division, running local, EMEA and global campaigns for Activision, Ubisoft, Tencent, EA, Riot Games, Epic Games, Team Vitality and the Esports World Cup.

I own the full chain, from insight and communication strategy to creative, social and influence plans, talent and partners, production, budgets, KPI tracking and post-campaign reporting.

Results include 4.23M impressions and #1 on Twitch and TikTok for Call of Duty, around 2M views for the Delta Force KOL activation, 1.5M+ engagement for Team Vitality and +800% engagement for PUBG Mobile. I also lead the agency's AI practice for luxury and beauty houses.

ART DIRECTOR
L'Ecole des Loisirs
2020 - 2022

UI/UX and brand designer for France's leading children's publisher, notably on its reading platform for 15 to 18 year olds.

ART DIRECTOR
Blizzard Entertainment
2014 - 2020

Six years in the marketing team, supporting every launch of the period: World of Warcraft, Overwatch, Hearthstone, StarCraft, Diablo III and Heroes of the Storm.

Campaigns across print, DOOH, FOOH, digital, 150+ eCRM, stunts and events, alongside brand, publishing and social media teams in EMEA and the US.

CO-FOUNDER/ART DIRECTOR
Asphalte
2017 - 2020

Co-founder of Asphalte, in charge of the brand from the ground up: name, visual identity, website, tone of voice, product naming, social presence and communications. A consistent system and a recognisable social voice helped Asphalte quickly establish itself in French menswear.

FASHION PHOTOGRAPHER
Repetto / Six&Sept
2012 - 2018

Self-taught photographer, I quickly began working with fashion brands, starting with *Repetto* on the lookbook and product imagery for its first ready-to-wear collection.

I later collaborated with *Pictoresq*, a French creative duo known for its cinematic and literary approach to fashion storytelling, before working with brands including *Six&Sept*, *Ann Tuil*, and *José* across photography, video, and motion design.

MUSIC LABEL OWNER
Beyond The Line
2010 - 2014

Co-founded an independent techno and house label in 2010. The project combined events, international bookings, DJ sets and partnerships, a loyal community built around the label, and full creative direction of its identity, posters and digital campaigns.

Education

MASTER'S DEGREE
Art Direction and Visual Communication Strategy
2012 - Paris XV[è]

PROFESSIONAL BACHELOR'S
Third year University Degree in Design Project Management
2011 - Marne-La-Vallée

BTS, VISUAL COMMUNICATION
Two-year Technical Degree in Visual Communication
2009 - Paris XIX[è]

BACCALAUREATE, APPLIED ARTS
French Secondary School Degree in Applied Arts
2007 - Bondy

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